

that it made sense. We were a little short of our target net worth when Peat Marwick eliminated the job I had held for four years and offered me a transfer to Los Angeles.

Vicki and I like Los Angeles. I was born there, Vicki and I met in college there, and we have family and friends there. But Los Angeles has some of the highest housing costs in the nation. The idea of buying a \$500,000 home and two new cars appealed as much as a proctosigmoidoscopy.

I could have requested a move someplace else. But I had already decided to retire. Why push for a special transfer, work to know new clients and build working relationships, and then quit? Life's too short to waste my time and everyone else's. I decided to take the plunge while the timing was good but not perfect.

HANDLING CHANGE

You retire and wake up that first morning with everything and yet nothing to do. You can stay in bed or get up. You can go to a movie or paint the house. You can go to the library or to Tibet.

But therein lies a problem. When you can do what you want, you don't always know what you want. Sorting through the possibilities can cause stress and worry.

Alvin Toffler's *Future Shock* came out in 1970. *Future Shock* popularized the conclusion that change makes us sick. Change can give us migraines, aching backs, diarrhea, ulcers, heart attacks, and nervous breakdowns. The direction of the change matters very little. The change itself—any change—takes a mental and physical toll. A divorce torments only slightly more than a marriage. Death and birth go opposite ways, but both cause stress. Getting fired causes concern, but so does getting a new job.

Dr. Thomas H. Holmes of the University of Washington put together a 100-point scale of major changes in our lives. Death of a spouse is 100—life's most traumatic change.